Web Accessibility Audit

Citylights Demo Site (W3C)

https://www.w3.org/WAI/demos/bad/before/home.html

Standard	WCAG 2.2 Level AA (EN 301 549 / European Accessibility Act)
Audit date	23 October 2026
Pages tested	4
Prepared by	Ahmed Basher
Overall risk	**HIGH**

1. Executive summary

We tested **4 pages** of https://www.w3.org/WAI/demos/bad/before/home.html against WCAG 2.2 Level AA, the technical standard behind the **European Accessibility Act (EAA)** and EN 301 549. We found **10 distinct accessibility barriers** affecting **238 elements**. Overall compliance risk is rated **HIGH**.

Severity	What it means	Issues	Elements
Critical	Blocks some users completely	3	138
Serious	Major difficulty for some users	4	41
Moderate	Noticeable difficulty	2	58
Minor	Inconvenience	1	1

Top priorities

• **Images must have alternative text** (122 elements, 4 of 4 pages) — Images have no text alternative, so screen-reader users hear nothing or just a file name.
• **Form elements must have labels** (11 elements, 1 of 4 pages) — Form fields have no label, so assistive technology cannot tell users what to type.
• **Select element must have an accessible name** (5 elements, 4 of 4 pages) — Drop-down menus have no accessible name.
• **Links must have discernible text** (19 elements, 4 of 4 pages) — Links have no readable text (often icon or image links), so users cannot tell where they go.
• **Elements must meet minimum color contrast ratio thresholds** (10 elements, 2 of 4 pages) — Text colour is too close to its background colour to be read comfortably.

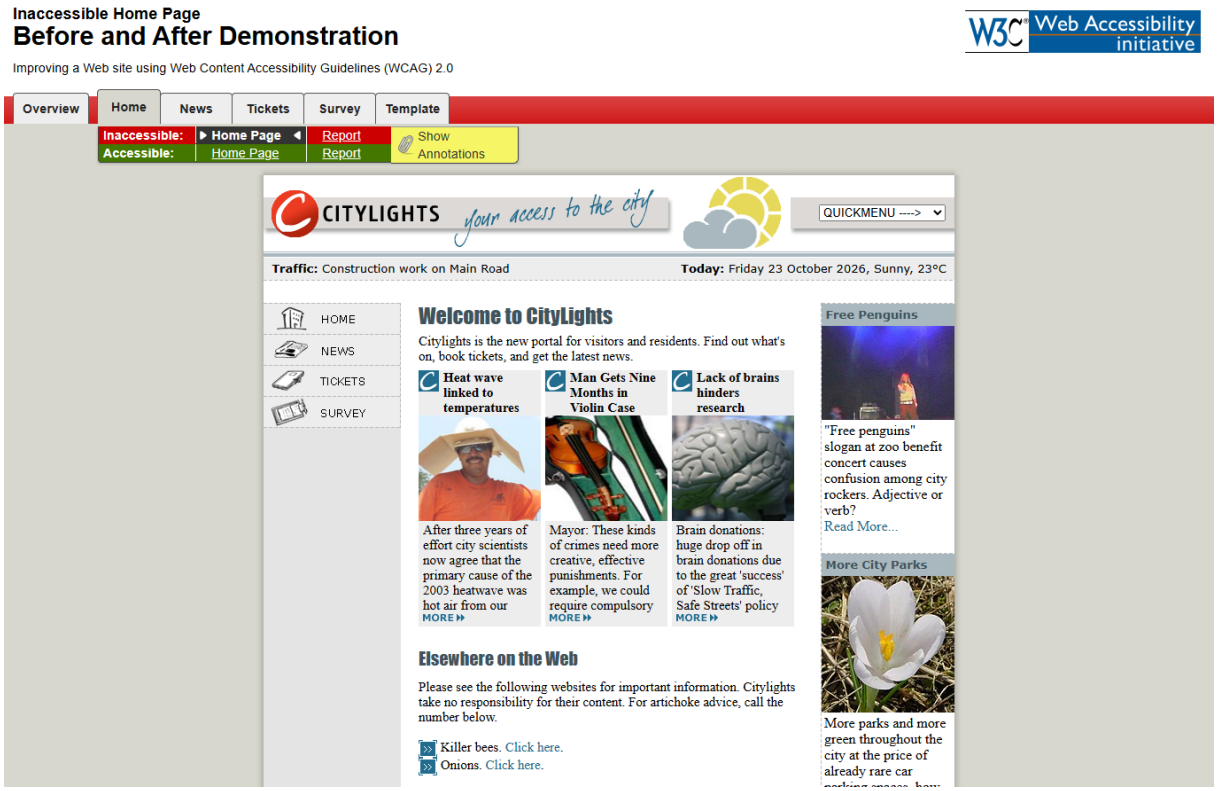
Why this matters

Since 28 June 2025 the EAA requires e-commerce, banking, transport, telecom and e-book services offered to EU consumers to be accessible. National authorities can order corrections and impose penalties, and French courts have already ordered a major retailer to make its site fully accessible within six months. Beyond compliance, accessible sites reach the roughly 1 in 4 EU adults living with a disability, and usually perform better in search and on mobile.

Note: automated testing reliably detects roughly a third of WCAG issues. Section 4 lists the manual checks needed for a complete conformance assessment.

2. Pages tested

#	Page	Issues	Elements
1	**Welcome to CityLights! [Inaccessible Home Page]** https://www.w3.org/WAI/demos/bad/before/home.html	8	69
2	**Welcome to CityLights! [Inaccessible News Page]** https://www.w3.org/WAI/demos/bad/before/news.html	7	54
3	**Welcome to CityLights! [Inaccessible Tickets Page]** https://www.w3.org/WAI/demos/bad/before/tickets.html	9	50
4	**Welcome to CityLights! [Inaccessible Survey Page]** https://www.w3.org/WAI/demos/bad/before/survey.html	8	65



Home page as tested

3. Detailed findings & how to fix them

3.1 Images must have alternative text

Severity	**Critical**	**WCAG**	1.1.1 Non-text Content
Affected	122 elements on pages 1, 2, 3, 4	**Who**	Blind and low-vision users

Problem: Images have no text alternative, so screen-reader users hear nothing or just a file name.
Fix: Add a meaningful alt attribute to every informative image (alt="Red running shoe, side view"). Decorative images get an empty alt="".

Example from your site:

```
<img src="./img/border_left_top.gif" width="10px" height="10px">
```

3.2 Form elements must have labels

Severity	**Critical**	**WCAG**	4.1.2 Name, Role, Value
Affected	11 elements on page 4	**Who**	Screen-reader and voice-control users

Problem: Form fields have no label, so assistive technology cannot tell users what to type.
Fix: Connect a visible <label for="id"> to each input, or use aria-label when a visible label is impossible.

Example from your site:

```
<input class="align" type="radio" name="res" value="1">
```

3.3 Select element must have an accessible name

Severity	**Critical**	**WCAG**	4.1.2 Name, Role, Value
Affected	5 elements on pages 1, 2, 3, 4	**Who**	Screen-reader and voice-control users

Problem: Drop-down menus have no accessible name.
Fix: Give every <select> a <label for> or aria-label describing what is being chosen.

Example from your site:

```
<select onchange="location.href = this.value;">
```

3.4 Links must have discernible text

Severity	**Serious**	**WCAG**	2.4.4 Link Purpose, 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value
Affected	19 elements on pages 1, 2, 3, 4	**Who**	Screen-reader and voice-control users

Problem: Links have no readable text (often icon or image links), so users cannot tell where they go.
Fix: Add visible link text, alt text on the image inside the link, or an aria-label.

Example from your site:

```
<a href="javascript:location.href='home.html';" onfocus="blur();"><img name="nav_home"
src="./img/nav_home.gif" width="88" height="27" hspace="15" border="0px"></a>
```

3.5 Elements must meet minimum color contrast ratio thresholds

Severity	Serious	**WCAG**	1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum)
Affected	10 elements on pages 1, 3	**Who**	Low-vision and colour-blind users, anyone on a phone in sunlight

Problem: Text colour is too close to its background colour to be read comfortably.
Fix: Raise contrast to at least 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text. Usually a small change to the brand palette fixes every instance.

Example from your site:

```
<b>Free Penguins</b>
```

3.6 All touch targets must be 24px large, or leave sufficient space

Severity	Serious	**WCAG**	2.5.8 Target Size (Minimum)
Affected	8 elements on pages 1, 2, 3, 4	**Who**	Users with motor impairments, all mobile users

Problem: Clickable targets are too small or too close together.
Fix: Make targets at least 24x24 CSS pixels or add spacing between them.

Example from your site:

```
<a href="./reports/home.html" class="report"><span class="hidden">Inaccessible Home Page </span>
Report</a>
```

3.7 <html> element must have a lang attribute

Severity	Serious	**WCAG**	3.1.1 Language of Page
Affected	4 elements on pages 1, 2, 3, 4	**Who**	Screen-reader users

Problem: The page does not declare its language, so screen readers may pronounce it wrongly.
Fix: Add lang="en" (or de, fr, ...) to the <html> element.

Example from your site:

```
<html>
```

3.8 All page content should be contained by landmarks

Severity	Moderate	**WCAG**	Best practice
Affected	54 elements on pages 1, 2, 3, 4	**Who**	Screen-reader users navigating by landmarks

Problem: Some content sits outside page regions (header, nav, main, footer).
Fix: Place all content inside semantic landmarks: <header>, <nav>, <main>, <footer>.

Example from your site:

```
<p id="logos"><a href="https://www.w3.org/" title="W3C Home"><img alt="W3C logo" src="../img/w3c.png"
height="48" width="72"></a><a href="https://www.w3.org/WAI/" title="WAI Home"><img alt="Web
Accessibility Initiative (
```

3.9 Document should have one main landmark

Severity	Moderate	**WCAG**	Best practice
Affected	4 elements on pages 1, 2, 3, 4	**Who**	Screen-reader and keyboard users

Problem: The page has no <main> region, so keyboard and screen-reader users cannot jump to the content.
Fix: Wrap the primary content in a single <main> element.

Example from your site:

```
<html>
```

3.10 Table header text should not be empty

Severity	Minor	**WCAG**	Best practice
Affected	1 elements on page 3	**Who**	Screen-reader users

Problem: Table header cells are empty, so data cells lose their context.
Fix: Add text to every <th>, or use <td> if the cell is not a header.

Example from your site:

```
<th style="padding-bottom:10px;"><img src="./img/headline_ticket_prices.gif" border="0"></th>
```

4. Manual testing checklist

These criteria cannot be verified by software and are tested by hand with keyboard-only navigation and the NVDA screen reader.

Check	Requirement	WCAG	Result
Keyboard only	Every link, button, menu and form can be reached and used with Tab / Shift+Tab / Enter / Space.	2.1.1	■ Pass ■ Fail
Visible focus	The element that has keyboard focus is always clearly visible.	2.4.7	■ Pass ■ Fail
No keyboard trap	Focus never gets stuck inside a pop-up, video or widget.	2.1.2	■ Pass ■ Fail
Skip link	A 'Skip to content' link lets keyboard users bypass the navigation.	2.4.1	■ Pass ■ Fail
Screen reader (NVDA)	Headings, images, buttons and form fields are announced meaningfully.	1.3.1 / 4.1.2	■ Pass ■ Fail
Form errors	Errors are described in text and tell the user how to fix them.	3.3.1 / 3.3.3	■ Pass ■ Fail
Zoom 200% / reflow	Content works at 200% zoom and at 320px width without horizontal scrolling.	1.4.4 / 1.4.10	■ Pass ■ Fail
Video & audio	Videos have captions; audio has a transcript.	1.2.2 / 1.2.1	■ Pass ■ Fail
Moving content	Carousels / animations can be paused.	2.2.2	■ Pass ■ Fail
Cookie banner & checkout	Consent banner and the full purchase flow work with keyboard and screen reader.	EAA core flow	■ Pass ■ Fail

5. Recommended next steps

1. **Fix critical and serious issues first** — they block users and carry the highest legal risk.
2. **Complete the manual checks** in Section 4, focusing on the checkout / booking flow.
3. **Publish an accessibility statement** on the site, as required by the EAA.
4. **Re-test after fixes** and add automated accessibility checks to future releases.

Methodology: pages were rendered in Google Chrome and tested with axe-core 4.10.3 using the WCAG 2.0/2.1/2.2 A and AA rule sets. This report is a technical assessment and does not constitute legal advice.